A-A-891B
June 23, 1981
SUPERSEDING
A-A-891A
June 27, 1980

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

TYPEWRITER
(ELECTRIC, SINGLE-ELEMENT)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This commercial item description covers heavy duty, office (non-portable) electric, single-element typewriters drawn from currently produced lots. Heavy duty refers to service classification capability of 10 years of 4 hours per day of business week typing application prior to overhaul, i.e., 30 million impressions prior to overall overhaul.

Salient characteristics:

Vertical line space selection with a minimum of three position (position 1, 6 line spaces per inch; position 2, 3 line spaces per inch, and position 3, manufacturer's optional).
Variable vertical spacer.
Paper bail with minimum of two bail rolls.
Adjustable paper guide.
Line finder device that permits ratchet-free movement of platen and return to original line of type.
Margin warning device.
Tabulator key (bar).
Tabulator set.
Tabulator clear.
Shift key (right and left).
Shift lock.
Shift lock release (right and left).
Margin release.
Carrier/carriage return with automatic line feed.
Backspace.
Space bar (forward spacing).
Margin set (right and left).
Repeat keys (forward spacer, backspace, underscore, and hyphen).
Interchangeable type (easily removed and replaced by operator).
Dust cover.
Pitch, designated in characters per horizontal inch (as specified).
One of the manufacturer's standard type style elements (as specified).
Maximum paper width and related maximum horizontal writing line width capability (as specified).
Color choice (as specified from colors available in contracted manufacturer's commercial selection).
Ribbon/cartridge system (as specified), i.e., two ribbon positions (ribbon and stencil) and automatic ribbon reverse required for cloth ribbon, but not for cartridge systems.
Conforms to UL Standard No. 114.

The issue of UL Standard 114 in effect on the date of the solicitation shall be used to determine compliance with this requirement.

Workmanship. Typewriters shall be clean, free from faulty construction or any defect which affects appearance, serviceability, or durability.

Electro-mechanical requirements:

Typewriters shall be equipped with resilient feet or base to minimize movement and prevent marring of furniture. Minimum carriage clearance, without riser, shall be 3-1/4 inches from desktop.

All keys and operating controls shall be easily accessible and, in no case, shall any controls be located on the typewriter back.

Unless otherwise specified, typewriter keyboards shall be in accordance with ANSI X4.7.

The issue of ANSI X4.7 in effect on the date of the solicitation shall be used to determine compliance with this requirement.

Typewriters shall operate on a 60 Hz, 115 V a.c power source, unless otherwise specified. When specified, the typewriters shall conform to electro-magnetic interference requirements of MIL-STD-461, -462, and -463 (On/Off switch except from the requirements of these three standards).

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Optional features, as specified:

Feature 1) Error correcting capability
Feature 2) Proportional spacing
Feature 3) Last line indicator
Feature 4) Dual pitch capability

Identification:

Each typewriter shall have the manufacturer's serial number permanently and legibly stamped or affixed on a major component in a readily accessible location. In addition, each typewriter shall be permanently and legiblymarked in a conspicuous location with the manufacturer's name or trademark.

Certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description, and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and is the same product sold in the commercial marketplace. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provision sof the contract.

Regulatory requirements. The manufacturer shall utilize recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable.

Packaging, packing, and marking. Packaging, packing, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

ANSI Standard X4.7 is available from the American National Standards Institute, 1430 Broadway, New York, NY 10018.

UL Standard 114 is available from Underwriters Laboratories, Inc., 333 Pfingsten Road, Northbrook, IL 60062.

Military Standards 461, 462, and 463 are available from Naval Publications and Forms Center, 5801 Tabor Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19120.

Preparing Activity:

GSA-FSS

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